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Child Safeguarding Policy

Boys to Men Mentorship Camp, an initiative of Potential Unexplored Ltd

Version 1 | November 2026 | To be reviewed by November 2027

Our commitment

Every boy who comes to the Boys to Men Mentorship Camp has the right to be safe, respected and heard. Parents trust us with their sons for the days of the camp, and we take that trust seriously. Safeguarding is not a paper we keep in a drawer. It shapes how every session, every conversation with a mentor and every day at the camp is run. We follow the laws of Uganda that protect children, including the Children Act.

This policy sets out what we promise, what we expect of every adult who works with the boys, and what happens when someone has a concern.

Who this policy covers

This policy applies to everyone who works with the boys or is present at the camp. That includes the leadership team, mentors and facilitators, guest speakers, volunteers, drivers and other helpers, and the staff of the venue while the camp is running. It protects every participant, from the youngest boy of 8 to the oldest young man of 23. Young men aged 18 to 23 are adults in law, but they are in our care at the camp and receive the same protection. They give their own consent where this policy asks for a parent's, and they sleep apart from the boys under 18.

Our principles

- The welfare of the boy comes first, before the name of the camp, the programme and any adult's convenience.
- Every boy is treated with dignity. He is never shamed, mocked, threatened or singled out.
- Boys are heard. A boy who raises a worry is listened to and taken seriously.
- Safeguarding is everyone's duty. Nobody who sees or hears a concern may leave it for someone else.
- Parents and guardians are partners, and they are kept informed before, during and after the camp.
- We act on a concern straight away, and we keep it private to those who need to know.

What we mean by harm

Harm takes many forms, and we watch for all of them.

- Physical harm, such as hitting, beating, rough handling, or forcing a boy to do something that hurts him.
- Emotional harm, such as shouting, insults, humiliation, threats, rejection or constant comparison with others.

- Sexual harm, such as any sexual contact, sexual talk, showing sexual material, or grooming a boy for abuse.
- Neglect, such as failing to give a boy food, rest, medical care, supervision or a safe place to sleep.
- Bullying and hazing, including older boys bullying younger ones, and including bullying through messages and social media.
- Exploitation, such as using a boy's time, work or image for the benefit of an adult.
- Discrimination, such as treating a boy worse because of his tribe, religion, disability, family background or school.

How we keep boys safe

Who works with the boys

No mentor works with the boys unless he or she is known personally to the leadership team. Every mentor gives the names of two referees, whom we contact, and declares in writing that he or she has never been convicted of, or charged with, an offence against a child. Anyone who will stay overnight with the boys is also asked for a Certificate of Good Conduct from the Uganda Police Force. Before working at the camp, every mentor speaks with the leadership team, is briefed on this policy, and signs the Code of Conduct in Annex A before meeting a boy. Guest speakers are hosted by a member of the leadership team and supervised throughout their session. They are never left alone with the boys. This includes the officers of the Uganda Police Force who facilitate the session on Law and Order.

Supervision

- No adult is ever alone with a single boy out of sight of others. One to one conversations take place in the open, or in a room with the door open, or with another adult nearby.
- At least two adults are present at every session and activity, so that no adult is ever the only one in charge of boys.
- Mentors are supervised throughout every session.
- Boys are grouped by age on arrival, and each group has its own facilitators. Older boys are never put in charge of younger boys.
- Boys are accounted for at every session, meal and bedtime. No boy leaves the venue without the knowledge of the leadership team.
- Boys sleep in rooms grouped by age. Young men aged 18 and above sleep apart from the boys under 18.
- Adults sleep in rooms close by, not in the boys' rooms. Night checks are done by two adults together, and no adult shares a bed or a sleeping room with a boy.
- Boys wash and change in private. Adults do not enter bathrooms or changing areas while boys are using them, except in an emergency, and then with another adult.
- When boys are transported, no adult travels alone in a vehicle with a single boy. In an emergency, a second adult joins as soon as one can be reached.

How we guide behaviour

The camp is training, coaching and mentorship. It is not a disciplinary or correctional programme. We do not shout, beat, shame, or deprive a boy of food or sleep, and we never use any punishment that hurts or humiliates. When a boy behaves badly, a mentor speaks with him calmly, finds out what lies behind it, and

agrees a way forward with him. If the problem continues, the leadership team speaks with his parent or guardian.

Sensitive topics

Some sessions deal with sensitive matters in a boy's life and growth. Mentors keep these sessions fitting for each age group. No boy is made to share a personal or painful story in front of others. If a boy shares something heavy with a mentor, the mentor listens, then passes it to the Safeguarding Lead. He or she does not try to carry it alone.

Physical safety and health

- Venues and activities are chosen with physical safety as the first test.
- Every boy brings a completed Basic Medical Examination Form. The team reads it before the camp, so that allergies, conditions and medication are known.
- Prescribed medication is labelled, kept by an adult and given at the right time.
- First aid is available throughout the camp, and the team knows the nearest health facility and how to reach it quickly.
- Parents are called without delay if a boy is unwell or injured.

Emergencies and leaving early

- If a boy is seriously ill or hurt, an adult takes him to the nearest health facility at once, and his parent or guardian is called on the way.
- If a boy goes missing, the leadership team starts a search at once, tells his parent or guardian, and informs the police if he is not found quickly.
- A boy leaves the camp early only with his parent or guardian, or with a person the parent has named to us beforehand.

Contact, gadgets and images

- Contact with boys goes through the camp's official channels, and parents know who is calling. Before the camp, Eduardo or Patricia calls each boy to prepare him. A boy is free to call Eduardo or Patricia whenever he wants.
- Mentors do not message boys privately on social media, and do not give boys gifts or favours outside the programme.
- No electronic gadgets of any kind are expected at the camp, which also reduces the risk of online harm.
- We photograph or film boys only for the purposes of the camp, and only with the consent of the parent or guardian. We never take pictures of a boy undressed or in a private space. We never publish a picture together with details that show where a boy lives. A parent may withdraw consent at any time.

Parents and visitors

Parents and family members join us on the closing Saturday. Visitors are received by the leadership team, are asked to sign in, and are not left alone with boys other than their own. The camp is held at schools that other people also use. Strangers are not allowed into the boys' areas, and staff of the venue are never left alone with the boys.

When a boy wants to speak up

On the first day, we tell the boys in plain words that they may speak to any mentor, or to Eduardo or Patricia, about anything that worries them, and that nobody will be punished for speaking up. We also tell them that some things cannot be kept secret, when keeping them would leave someone in danger. On the last day, every boy also has a chance to say, privately, how the week went and whether anything worried him. A boy or a parent may raise a concern after the camp too, by calling or writing to the people listed at the end of this policy.

If you have a concern

This applies to every adult at the camp, and to parents too.

1. **Stay calm and listen.** Let the boy say it in his own words. Do not ask leading questions or press for details.
2. **Do not promise to keep it secret.** Explain that you must tell the person whose job is to keep him safe.
3. **Make sure he is safe now.** If he is in danger or needs medical care, act at once.
4. **Write it down.** Note what was said, when, and who was there, using his own words as far as you can.
5. **Report it the same day** to the Safeguarding Lead. If the concern is about the Safeguarding Lead, report it to Banio Luiji Nobert. If it is about Banio, report it to Eduardo or Patricia. Where a boy is in danger, or you fear a concern will not be dealt with, you may go straight to the police or to Sauti 116.
6. **Keep it private.** Do not discuss it with anyone who does not need to know, and do not confront the person concerned.

How we respond

The Safeguarding Lead acts on the same day. He or she records the concern, decides on the immediate steps, and informs the boy's parent or guardian, unless doing so would put the boy at greater risk. Where a boy may have been harmed or is in danger, we report to the proper authorities, such as the Uganda Police Force Child and Family Protection Unit or the district Probation and Social Welfare Officer, and we support the boy and his family. The report is made within 24 hours. Nobody at the camp investigates a crime. We protect the boy and hand the matter to those whose work it is. Anyone may also call Sauti 116, the Uganda Child Helpline.

Where the concern is about a mentor or any other adult, that person is removed from contact with the boys at once while the matter is looked into. The leadership team looks into it fairly. If the concern is serious, it is reported to the police, and the person does not return to the camp.

Concerns between boys, such as bullying, are dealt with calmly and seriously. We support the boy who was harmed and the boy who caused the harm, and we tell the parents of both.

Nobody is punished or treated badly for raising a concern in good faith.

Confidentiality and records

Records of concerns are written, dated and kept securely. Only the Safeguarding Lead and the Founder can see them, and if a concern is about one of them, that person does not see the record. Information is shared only with those who need it to keep a boy safe. Registration details and medical forms are kept in a private folder that only the leadership team can open, in line with the Data Protection and Privacy Act of Uganda.

The part parents play

- Tell us about any health need, fear or family situation that may affect your son.
- Read this policy, and talk with your son before the camp. Tell him he can always speak up, and that he may call Eduardo or Patricia.
- Tell us at once if you have a concern about anything, however small it seems.
- Collect your son at the close of the camp, or tell us beforehand if he must leave early. If someone else will collect him, give us his or her name in advance.

Training and review

Before every camp, the leadership team briefs all mentors and helpers on this policy and the Code of Conduct. After every camp, we review what went well and what must improve, including any concerns that were raised. We review this policy at least once a year, and after any serious incident.

Who to speak to

Role	Name	Contact
Safeguarding Lead	Eduardo Fortunato Atibuni, Managing Director, Boys to Men	+256 757 340 592
Deputy Safeguarding Lead	Kokora Patricia, Administration	+256 775 502 323
Founder and Lead Mentor	Banio Luiji Nobert	+256 775 495 431
Email	info@potentialunexplored.com	
Uganda Child Helpline, Sauti 116.		

Annex A Code of Conduct for mentors, staff and volunteers

Everyone who works with the boys signs this Code before meeting a boy.

I will

- Treat every boy with respect, and listen when he speaks.
- Be a good example in my words, my dress and my behaviour.
- Keep all contact with boys in the open and within the programme.
- Report any concern the same day to the Safeguarding Lead.
- Speak up if I see another adult break this Code.
- Follow the medical and other needs of each boy as shared with me.

I will not

- Hit, shout at, threaten, shame or mock a boy.
- Be alone with a boy out of sight of others, or share a bed or sleeping room with him.
- Go into the boys' sleeping areas alone at night, or enter a bathroom or changing area while boys are using it.
- Touch a boy in any way that is not appropriate, open and welcome.
- Make sexual jokes or comments, or show a boy sexual or violent material.
- Give a boy gifts, money or favours, or ask him for any.
- Message a boy privately, or ask a boy to keep a secret.
- Take or share pictures of a boy without the consent of his parent or guardian.
- Use alcohol, tobacco or drugs at the camp or in the presence of boys.
- Treat any boy worse because of his tribe, religion, disability or background, or show favourites.

I have read the Child Safeguarding Policy of the Boys to Men Mentorship Camp and I agree to follow this Code of Conduct. I declare that I have never been convicted of, or charged with, an offence against a child. I understand that if I break this Code, I may be removed from the camp, and if the law has been broken, the matter may be reported to the police.

Name	
Role at the camp	
Signature	
Date	